

BIS INFORMATION & KNOWLEDGE BASE

Reference document for an AI assistant focused on Indian Standards, BIS product certification, conformity assessment and consumer services.

Important: This document is a structured knowledge summary based on publicly available Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) information. It is not a substitute for the latest Act, Rules, Regulations, Quality Control Orders, Indian Standards, licences, product manuals or official BIS decisions. For legally or technically critical questions, the assistant should direct users to the current official BIS source.

1. Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)

- The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) is India's national standards body. Its work includes standardization and conformity assessment activities intended to support quality, safety, reliability and consumer protection.
- BIS provides information and services for standards, product certification, conformity assessment, hallmarking, consumer engagement and related activities.
- The BIS framework is governed principally by the BIS Act, 2016 and associated Rules and Regulations. Conformity assessment schemes are provided under the BIS (Conformity Assessment) Regulations, 2018.

2. Purpose of Indian Standards

- Indian Standards specify requirements, characteristics, test methods, codes of practice or other technical criteria for products, processes, services or systems.
- Standards can help create common technical requirements, support product quality and safety, facilitate testing and conformity assessment, and improve consistency for manufacturers, purchasers and consumers.
- Whether a particular Indian Standard is mandatory depends on the applicable legal or regulatory framework. A standard should not be assumed to be compulsory merely because it exists.

3. BIS Product Certification

- BIS product certification provides a conformity-assessment mechanism through which eligible manufacturers can obtain rights to use an applicable BIS Standard Mark for products conforming to the relevant Indian Standard and applicable scheme requirements.
- Under Scheme-I, BIS describes assessment of manufacturing infrastructure, process controls, quality-control and testing capabilities, together with establishing product conformity through testing.
- During operation of a licence, BIS may conduct surveillance activities and testing to monitor continued conformity.

4. BIS Licence

- A BIS licence is a licence granted under Section 13 of the BIS Act, 2016 to use a specified Standard Mark in relation to goods or an article that conforms to a standard.
- An applicant manufacturer needs appropriate manufacturing infrastructure, process controls, quality-control arrangements and testing capabilities for the relevant product and standard.
- BIS grants a licence based on assessment of the manufacturer's capabilities and establishment of product conformity through applicable testing arrangements.

5. ISI Mark / BIS Standard Mark

- The ISI Mark is commonly associated with BIS product certification under Scheme-I. A valid Standard Mark indicates conformity with the relevant Indian Standard under the applicable BIS certification arrangement.
- A consumer should not assume that a product is BIS certified merely because it displays text such as 'as per IS' or a symbol resembling the ISI Mark.
- Use official BIS verification facilities when checking a licence, certification status or other current product information.

6. Voluntary and Compulsory Certification

- BIS certification is generally voluntary in nature. However, the Central Government can make compliance with specified Indian Standards compulsory for particular products through applicable legal instruments.
- Products subject to compulsory requirements may require a BIS Standard Mark under a licence or Certificate of Conformity, depending on the applicable scheme and notification.
- The fact that a product category is regulated can change over time. Always verify the current official list and applicable Quality Control Order (QCO) before giving a compliance answer.

7. Quality Control Orders (QCOs)

- A Quality Control Order is a government regulatory instrument used to make compliance with specified Indian Standards compulsory for specified products.
- Official BIS information states that compulsory requirements may be introduced for considerations including public interest, protection of human, animal or plant health, environmental safety, prevention of unfair trade practices and national security.
- For a product covered by a QCO, the applicable notification determines the requirements, implementation date, product scope and conformity route.

8. BIS Conformity Assessment Schemes

- BIS provides multiple conformity-assessment schemes. The applicable scheme depends on the product, notification and regulatory framework.
- Scheme-I is associated with a licence to use the Standard Mark.
- Scheme-II is a registration scheme used for specified products.
- Scheme-IV provides for a Certificate of Conformity for specified products.
- Scheme-X is another certification route for products covered by its applicable provisions.
- The assistant must not infer the applicable scheme from product name alone; it should check the current official BIS information and applicable notification.

9. Product Certification Process — High-Level

- 1. Identify the relevant product and Indian Standard.
- 2. Check whether certification is voluntary or compulsory and identify the applicable scheme/QCO.
- 3. Review the applicable BIS guidelines, product manual and Scheme of Inspection and Testing where relevant.

- 4. Ensure manufacturing, process-control, quality-control and testing capabilities meet applicable requirements.
- 5. Apply through the applicable BIS process.
- 6. BIS assesses the manufacturing and testing capabilities and establishes product conformity through applicable testing.
- 7. If requirements are satisfied, the applicable licence or certificate can be granted.
- 8. During operation, surveillance, testing, renewal, scope changes or other actions may apply depending on the scheme and product.

10. Product-Specific Information

- BIS publishes product-specific information for relevant certification activities. This can include Product Manuals, Scheme of Inspection and Testing (SIT), grouping guidelines and product-specific guidelines.
- Product-specific requirements are critical. A generic BIS explanation should not be treated as the technical requirements for a particular product.
- For technical compliance questions, identify the exact product, Indian Standard number/revision, applicable scheme and current notification before answering.

11. Testing and Conformity

- Testing is an important part of establishing conformity with applicable Indian Standards.
- Depending on the applicable arrangement, conformity may involve third-party laboratory testing, testing at the manufacturing premises, or a combination of testing arrangements.
- Testing requirements, sample requirements and acceptance criteria are product- and scheme-specific. The assistant should not invent test values or acceptance limits.

12. Surveillance and Market Monitoring

- BIS certification is not necessarily a one-time event. BIS information describes surveillance activities during the operation of licences.
- Surveillance can include visits to licensee premises and testing of products drawn from factories or the open market.
- Market surveillance and enforcement activities help address non-conforming products and misuse of the Standard Mark.

13. Non-Conformity and Unsatisfactory Performance

- BIS provides specific guidelines for dealing with product non-conformity and unsatisfactory performance under applicable certification processes.
- Corrective action, retesting, licence-related action or other measures depend on the applicable scheme, product and circumstances.
- The assistant should not prescribe a penalty or compliance outcome without the applicable current BIS rule or guideline.

14. Renewal, Retesting and Change in Scope

- BIS provides procedures and guidelines relating to renewal of licences, retesting of samples and change in scope of licences.
- These procedures are not identical for every product or conformity-assessment scheme.
- For a current procedural answer, identify the scheme and product and consult the applicable current BIS guideline.

15. Consumer Services and Complaints

- BIS provides consumer-oriented services and complaint mechanisms.
- Complaints can relate to quality of BIS-certified products, misuse of the BIS Standard Mark, violation of Quality Control Orders, misleading claims of conformity to Indian Standards, services rendered by BIS and other matters.
- Consumers should use official BIS complaint and verification channels for current procedures and contact details.

16. How Consumers Should Verify a BIS Claim

- Check the product's marking and certification information.
- Look for the applicable BIS Standard Mark and licence or registration information where applicable.
- Verify the claim through official BIS search/verification facilities rather than relying only on packaging, seller statements or third-party websites.
- If the marking appears suspicious or misleading, use the official BIS complaint/enforcement mechanism.

17. Important Terms

- Indian Standard (IS): A technical standard published/adopted by BIS.
- Standard Mark: A BIS mark used under applicable conformity-assessment arrangements.
- ISI Mark: Common term associated with the BIS Standard Mark under product certification Scheme-I.
- Licence: Authorization under the BIS Act to use a specified Standard Mark in relation to conforming goods/articles.
- Certificate of Conformity (CoC): A conformity-assessment document used under applicable BIS schemes.
- Quality Control Order (QCO): A government order that can make specified standards compulsory for specified products.
- Surveillance: Monitoring activities used to assess continuing conformity during operation of a certification/licence.
- Product Manual: Product-specific document describing applicable certification requirements and procedures where published.
- Scheme of Inspection and Testing (SIT): Product-specific inspection/testing requirements used in applicable certification processes.

18. Safe Answering Rules for the AI Assistant

- Do not invent Indian Standard numbers, revision years, test limits, certification fees, licence validity, QCO dates or penalties.

- Do not claim a product requires BIS certification without checking the current applicable official source.
- Do not treat a general Indian Standard as automatically mandatory.
- Prefer current official BIS sources for regulatory, certification and service information.
- When the knowledge base does not contain enough evidence, say that the available knowledge is insufficient and identify what information is needed.
- For technical or legal compliance questions, distinguish general guidance from product-specific requirements.
- When a user asks for an exact requirement, retrieve the relevant official document and cite the document/chunk rather than relying on general model knowledge.

19. Example Questions This Knowledge Base Supports

- What is BIS?
- What is the purpose of Indian Standards?
- What is a BIS licence?
- What is the ISI Mark?
- Is BIS certification mandatory for every product?
- What is a Quality Control Order?
- What are the main BIS conformity-assessment schemes?
- What does the BIS product certification process involve?
- What capabilities should a manufacturer have before applying?
- What is product surveillance?
- What is market surveillance?
- What can a consumer do about a suspected fake ISI Mark?
- What types of complaints can be submitted to BIS?
- What information should I identify before asking about BIS certification for a product?

20. Official Reference Sources

BIS Product Certification FAQ

<https://www.bis.gov.in/product-certification/product-certification-faq/?lang=en>

BIS Product Certification Process

<https://www.bis.gov.in/product-certification/product-certification-process/?lang=en>

BIS Products under Compulsory Certification

<https://www.bis.gov.in/product-certification/products-under-compulsory-certification/?lang=en>

BIS Consumer FAQ

<https://www.bis.gov.in/consumer-overview/for-consumers-faq/?lang=en>

BIS Product Certification Overview

<https://www.bis.gov.in/product-certification/product-certification-overview/?lang=en>

Document note: This knowledge base is intended for retrieval-augmented AI assistance. Official BIS sources should remain the authority for current legal, regulatory, certification and technical requirements.